

NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY PLACEMENT CONTACT: Graduate Program Office
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS gradecon@northeastern.edu
301 Lake Hall, 360 Huntington Avenue, Boston, MA 02115 (617) 373-2882

DAYANARA M. DIAZ VARGAS

diazvargas.d@northeastern.edu | 617-692-0955 | www.dayanaradiazvargas.com

BUSINESS ADDRESS:

Department of Economics
Northeastern University
321 Holmes Hall
360 Huntington Avenue
Boston, MA 02115-5000

DESIRED RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS:

Primary: Health Economics. **Secondary:** Labor Economics.

EDUCATION:

	DEGREE	DATE	FIELD
Northeastern University	Ph.D.	2027 (expected)	Economics
Northeastern University	M.S.	2022	Economics
University of Puerto Rico	M.B.A.	2019	Business Administration
University of Puerto Rico	B.A.	2017	Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER:

“Healthcare Privatization and Patient Health: Evidence from Puerto Rico.” Job Market Paper, 2026. [\[Draft\]](#)

Abstract: This paper estimates the effects on population health of shifting a large publicly financed healthcare system from direct public provision to private management. We study Puerto Rico’s 1994–2000 health reform, which combined changes in facility control, payment incentives, eligibility, and access. Exploiting the reform’s staggered rollout across counties, we estimate an increase in all-cause mortality of 26.96 deaths per 100,000 residents annually, equivalent to 3.7 percent of the pre-treatment mean. The mortality increase is accompanied by a contraction in ambulatory healthcare services, fewer hospitals, and lower use of early prenatal care, consistent with reduced provider capacity and access to timely care as possible mechanisms. The estimated mortality increase persists across alternative specifications and identification strategies. These findings suggest health costs from a broad reorganization of publicly financed care and support evaluating patient outcomes and provider capacity alongside expenditure when assessing transitions to private management.

WORKING PAPERS:

- “Corporate Tax Incentives Retraction: Evidence from Puerto Rico.” Working Paper, 2026. [\[Draft\]](#)

Abstract: We know much about the effects of introducing place-based tax incentives for corporations. Given how costly these incentives are, we know surprisingly little about their effects once they are retracted. To fill this gap, this paper studies the retraction of one of the costliest corporate tax incentives in the United States, Section 936 of the U.S. Internal Revenue Code. This incentive exempted U.S. corporations from federal tax on income earned in Puerto Rico from 1976 until Congress phased it out beginning in 1996 and eliminated it in 2006. Manufacturing claimed 98 percent of the tax credits and produced a median 45.5 percent of island GDP at the time, making it one of the most important industries in the economy. Using synthetic difference-in-differences on employment data for Puerto Rico and U.S. states, this paper estimates that manufacturing employment fell 9.2 percent by 2000, 13.3 percent by the close of the phase-out in 2005, and 28.0 percent by 2019, relative to the counterfactual. Results show no return to baseline employment levels two decades later. The average county-level decline is 13.6 percent,

and reaches 18.2 percent in high-poverty counties. This evidence leads us to conclude that even after three decades of tax subsidy, the retraction of place-based tax incentives fails to ignite self-sustaining industries.

WORK IN PROGRESS:

- “Physician Migration from Puerto Rico and the Health of Receiving Communities” (with Jori Barash, University of Oregon)

Abstract: This paper studies whether physician arrivals improve healthcare access and population health in receiving communities. Physicians’ location choices make it difficult to distinguish the effects of physician supply from differences in local healthcare demand. We examine physician migration from Puerto Rico to mainland U.S. counties following Hurricane Maria in September 2017. Our proposed instrumental variables strategy uses the pre-hurricane geographic distribution of the Puerto Rican diaspora to predict physician arrivals. Using data from 2012 to 2022, we study hospital use, preventable hospitalizations, access to care, and mortality, with attention to differences across physician specialties.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE:

- Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Northeastern University (Summer 2024)
Dr. John Kwoka. Built case records on concluded FTC antitrust matters for a retrospective study of remedy effectiveness.
- Research Assistant, D’Amore-McKim School of Business, Northeastern University (2021–2024)
Dr. Shawn Bhimani. Supply Trace project. Led a team of four research assistants tracing apparel production networks.
- Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Northeastern University (Spring 2023)
Dr. Bilge Erten. Contributed to Dave, Erten, Keskin, and Zhang, *Journal of Health Economics* 104 (2025), 103073.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE:

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Northeastern University

- Recitation for Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 1125) — Fall 2026, Spring 2026, Spring 2025, Fall 2024, Summer 2024 | Dr. Jill Dupree, Dr. Peter Simon
 - Lecture course enrollment (ECON 1115): 400 | Four recitation sections per term, two in Spring 2026
 - Independently designed and taught a weekly discussion on the course material, integrating macroeconomic theory with current news and relevant applications, including original presentations and examples.
 - Supervised, guided, and graded student’s case studies projects on macroeconomic issues.
 - Held office hours, and graded problem sets, discussion boards, and exams
- Microeconomic Theory (ECON 2316) — Spring 2026, Spring 2023 | Dr. Shantanu Khanna
- Statistics for Economists (ECON 2350) — Summer 2025 | Dr. Gustavo Vicentini
- Contested Economic Issues (ECON 1260) — Summer 2024 | Dr. Peter Simon
- Applied Econometrics (ECON 2560) — Fall 2023, two sections | Dr. Mark Hooker
- Global Political Economy (INTL 3520) — Spring 2023 | Dr. Bilge Erten

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

- Ignite@AG Extern, Analysis Group, Boston, MA (July 2025)
Selected as one of 14 externs from 400 applicants for the firm’s Associate Externship Program. Led a carriage dispute case exercise, working from litigation materials.
- Quantitative Analyst, Enterprise Risk Management, FirstBank Puerto Rico (2019–2021)
Validated econometric, financial, and machine learning models and certified model documentation.
- Economist and Researcher, Inteligencia Economica Inc., Guaynabo, PR (2019)

Wrote feasibility studies for small businesses, international corporations, and government institutions.

GRANTS AND FUNDING:

- David A. Radivonyk Fund for Student Research in Economics, Northeastern University, 2021 (\$1,000)
- Damaso “Tom” Acevedo Endowment Fund, University of Puerto Rico, 2017–2019 (\$1,500)

FELLOWSHIPS AND HONORS:

- 2022–2027 Ph.D. Excellence Fellowship, Northeastern University. Three summers of full funding and a \$2,500 research allowance.
- 2026 Participant, AEA Mentoring Program and the AEA Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP)

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS:

- 2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference, “Fifty States, Fifty Systems: State Policy Variations and Impacts,” Boston, MA (scheduled)
- 2026 AEA Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference, Washington, DC
- 2026 American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN
- 2024–2026 Economics Workshop, Department of Economics, Northeastern University (once per semester, including summer)
- 2024 Development Reading Group, Boston University

REFERENCES:

- **Dr. Shantanu Khanna** (Chair), Assistant Professor of Public Policy and Economics, Northeastern University — s.khanna@northeastern.edu
- **Dr. James Dana**, Professor of Economics and Strategy, Department of Economics and D’Amore-McKim School of Business, Northeastern University — j.dana@northeastern.edu
- **Dr. Mindy Marks**, Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Northeastern University — m.marks@northeastern.edu

OTHER INFORMATION:

Software: R, Python, SQL, STATA, JavaScript, LaTeX

Professional Memberships: American Economic Association; American Society of Health Economists; American Society of Hispanic Economists; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

Languages: Spanish (native), English (native), French (basic)

Citizenship: United States